

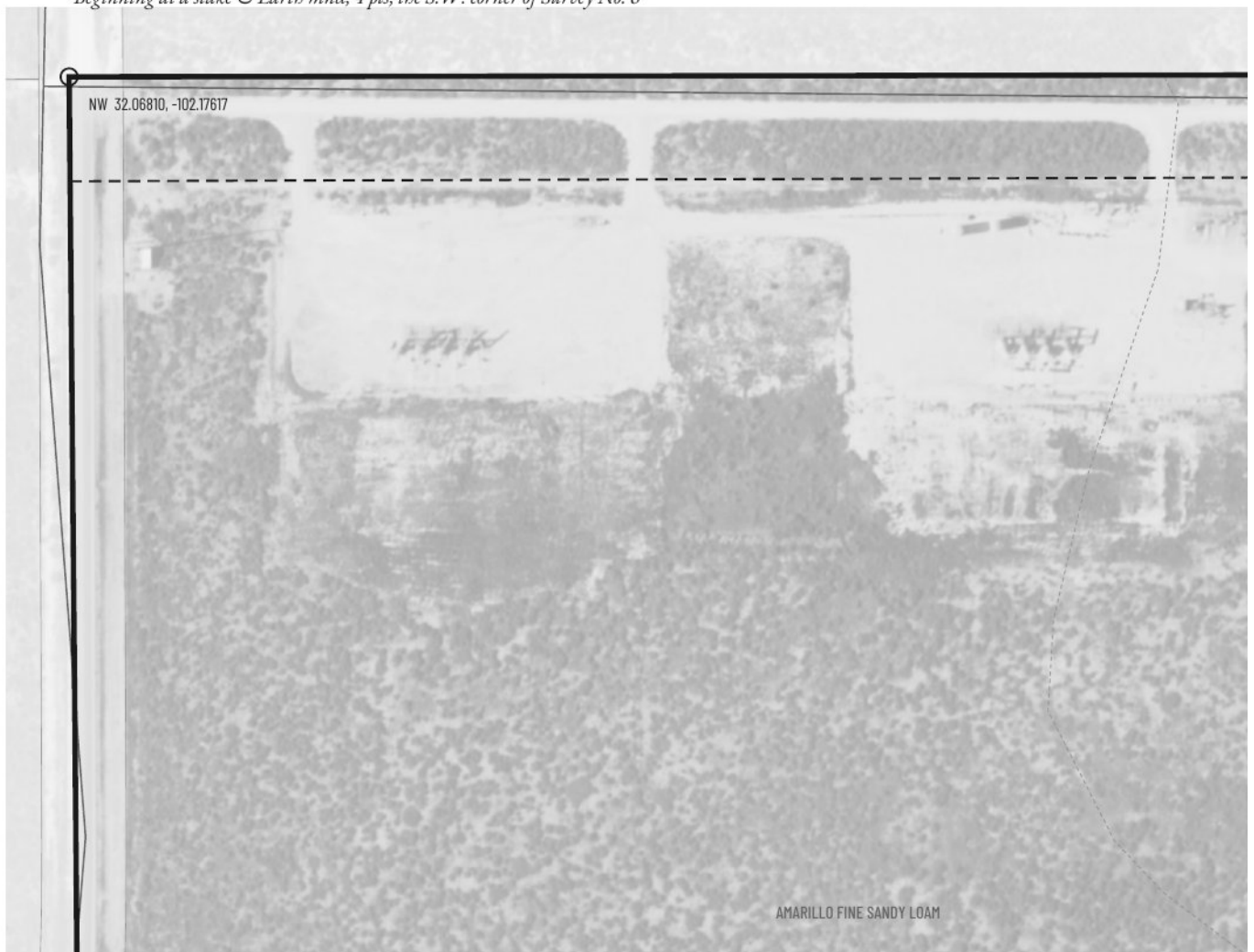
SECTION

Block 39, Township 1 South, Texas & Pacific Railway Company Survey · Abstract 3

ONE SQUARE MILE *Desk Edition. Compiled from records, not walked.*

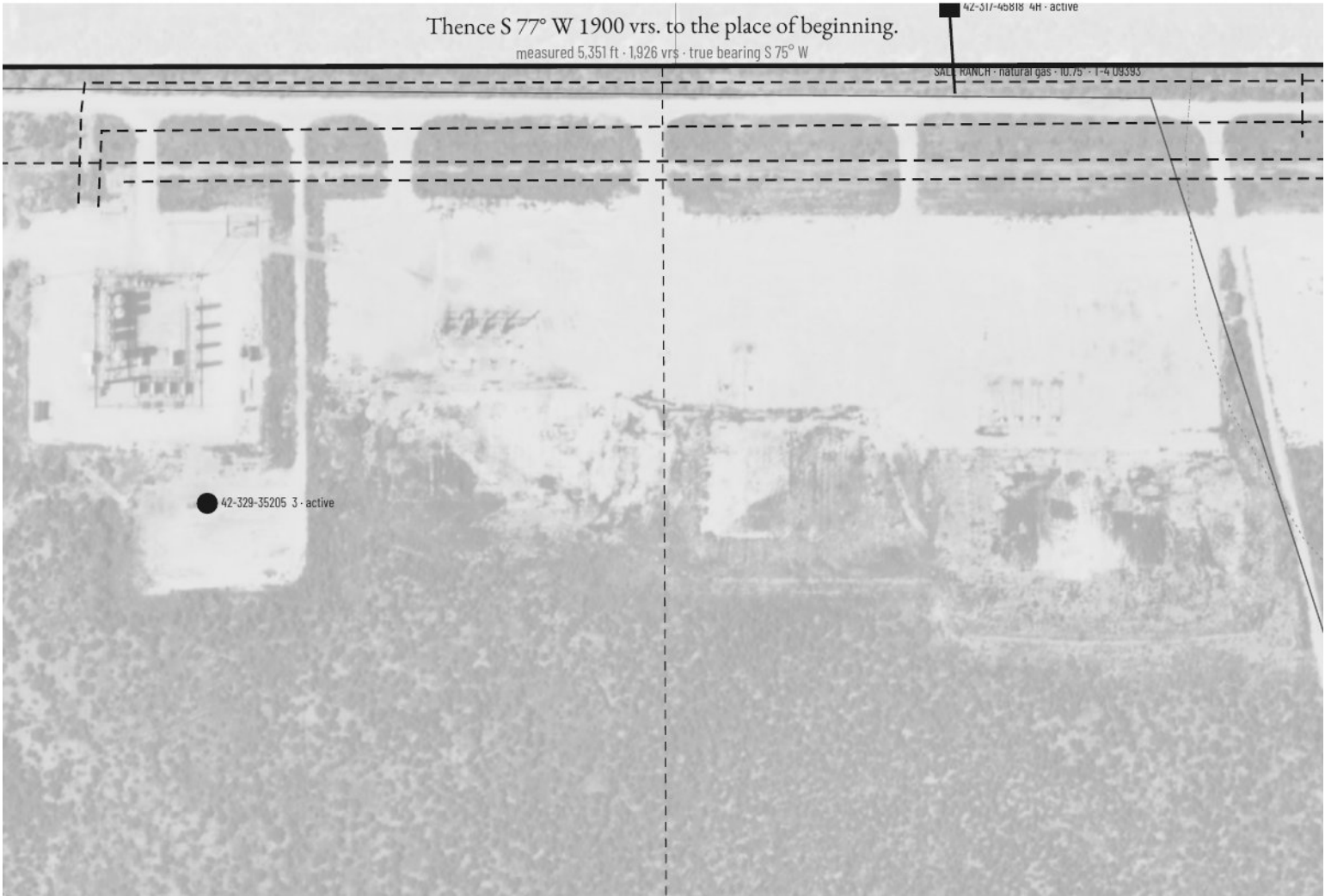
First edition, October 2026. One copy. Corrections invited; anyone who corrects it gets the second edition free.

Beginning at a stake & Earth mound, 4 pls, the S.W. corner of Survey No. 6

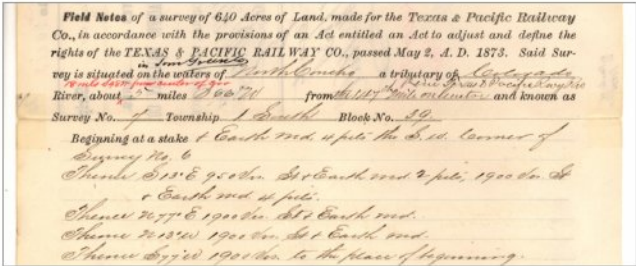


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34 · Midland County, Texas

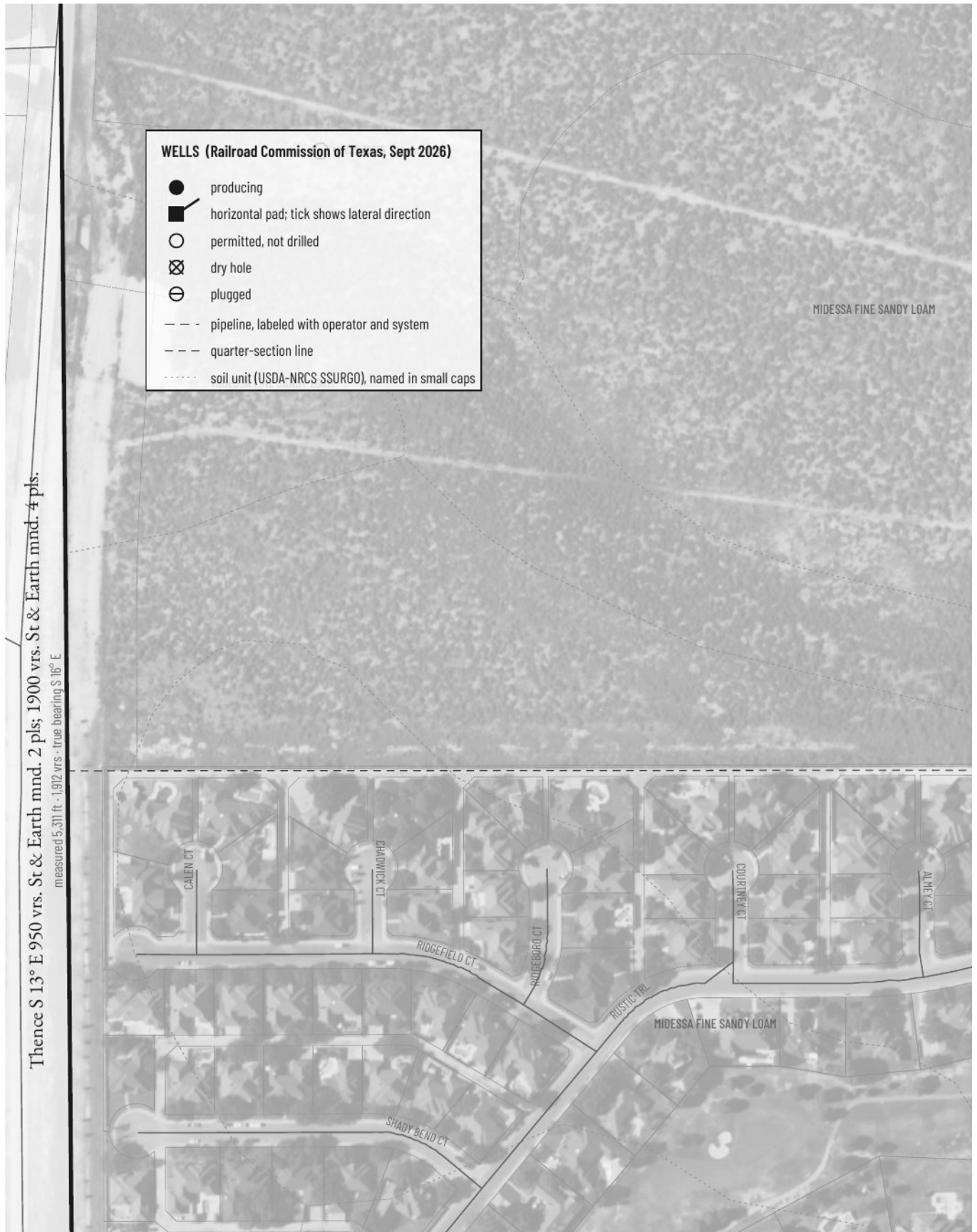


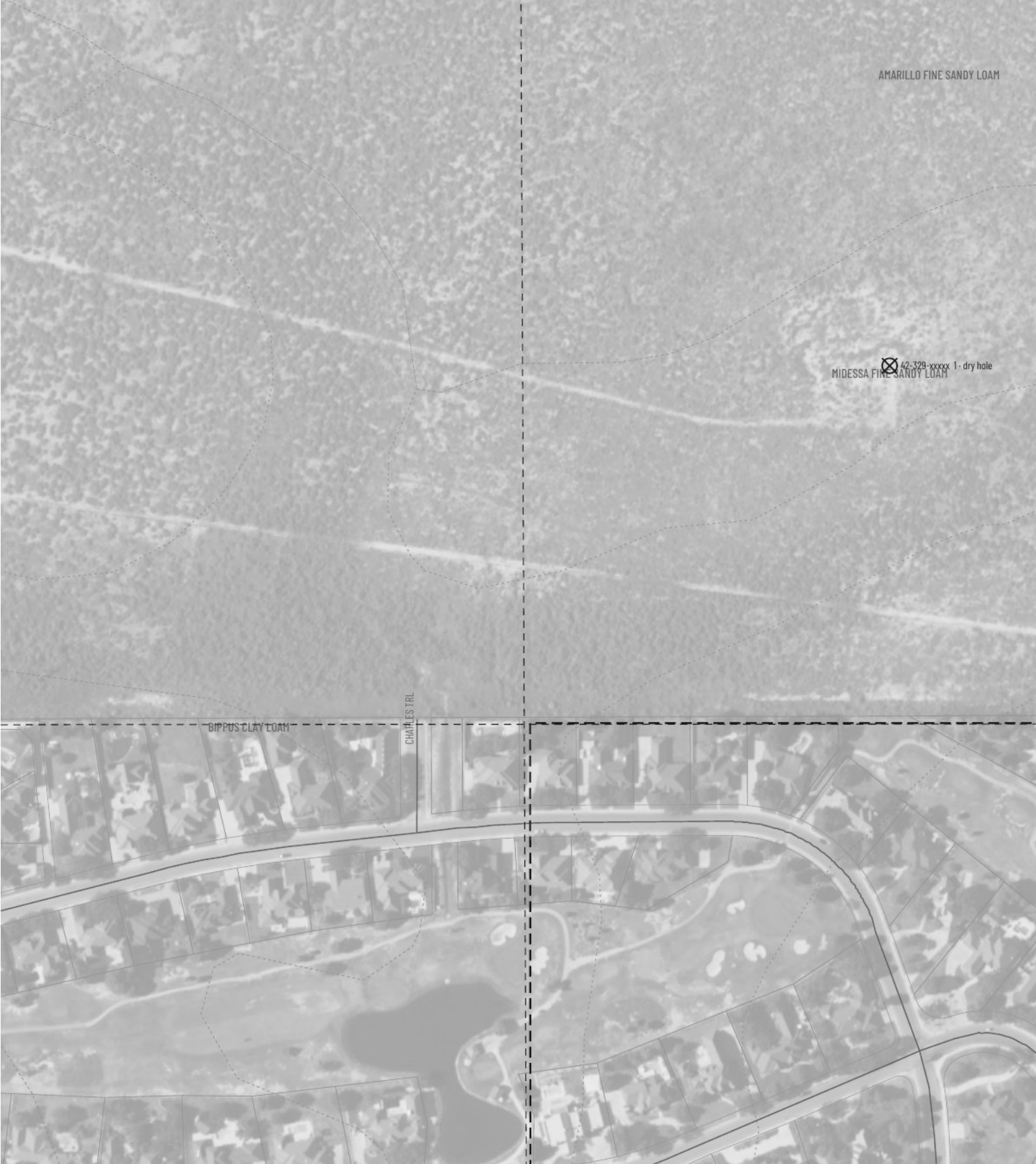
Surveyed 1 February 1876 and docketed under Martin County. Corrected to Midland County in red ink, 1887, two years after Midland County was organized. The county this ground sits in was itself a correction. On this sheet, red means the record disagreed with itself, or ran out.

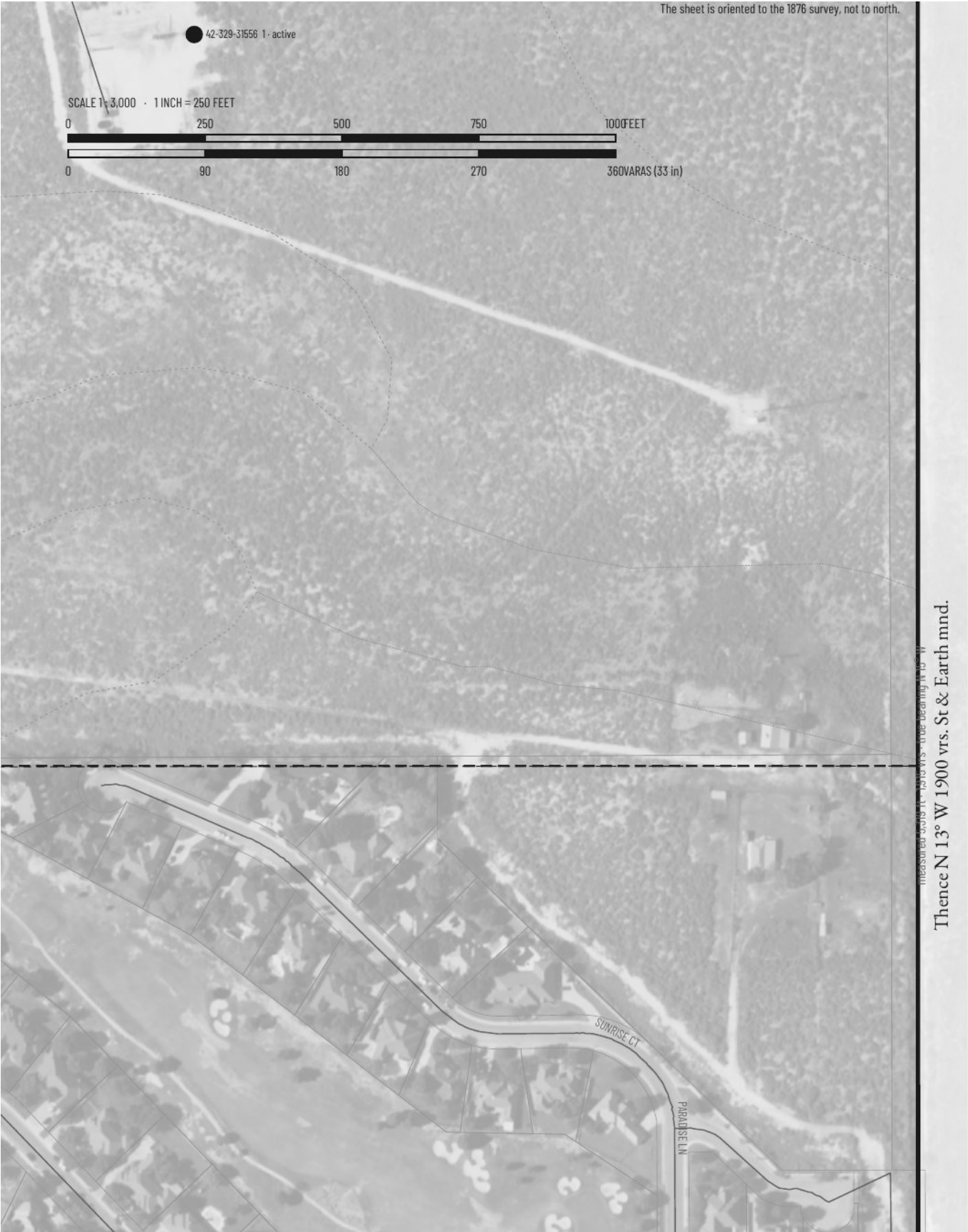


Powell's field notes, 1 Feb 1876, as filed. "Martin," struck. GLO Bexar Scrip File 020113.







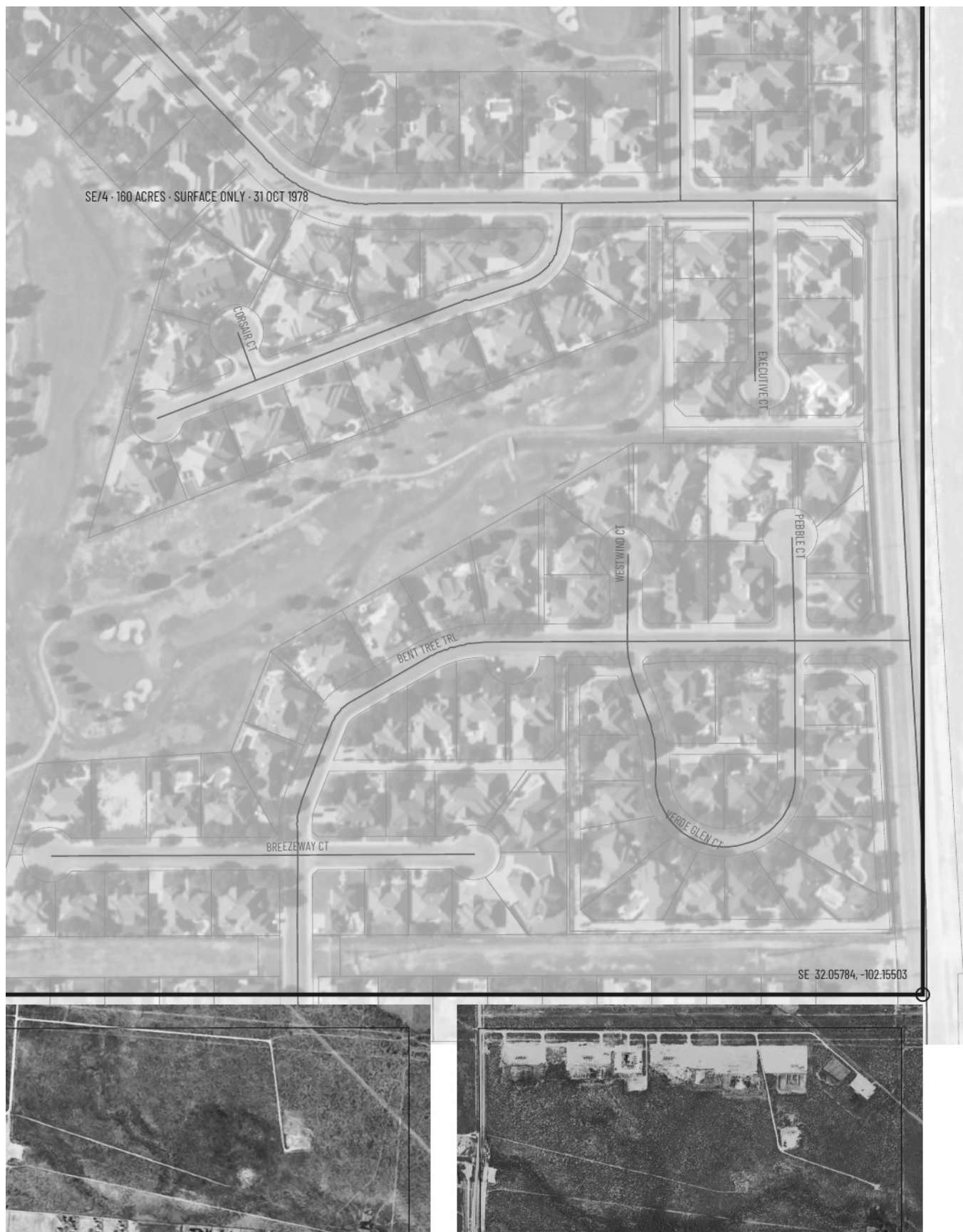


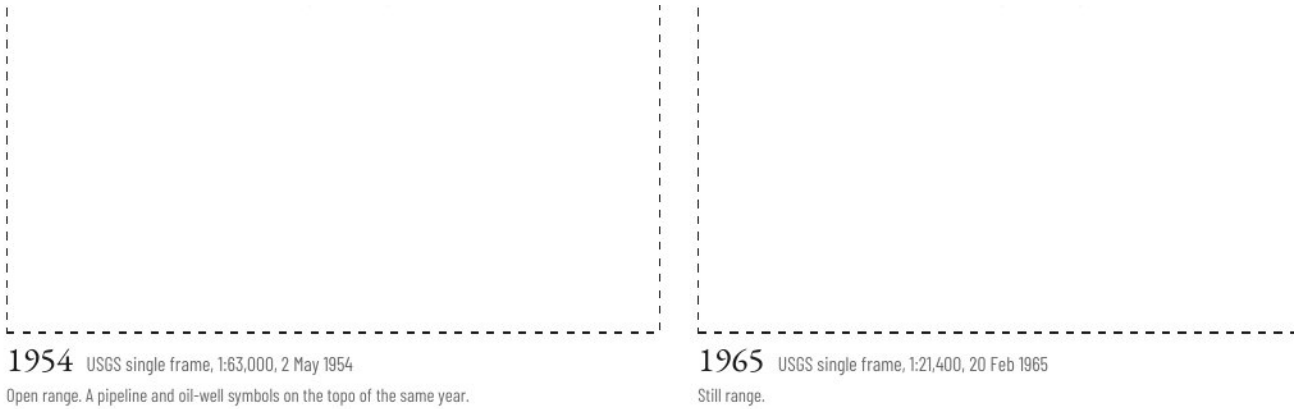


FRAME NOT YET ALIGNED

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CHAIN OF TITLE, 1876-1982

1876. Surveyed 1 Feb by deputy surveyor W.C. Powell, chain carriers L.E. Wright and E.C. Bennett, “on the waters of N Concho.” Bearings in varas. Filed at the General Land Office 27 Dec.

1876. Land Scrip No. 3123, 25 May: the Texas & Pacific has built 203 miles, 4,624 feet of railroad. This section is p what that construction earned. Odd-numbered — railroad land, not school land.

1883. Patented 15 Dec to Texas and Pacific Railway Co. Patent 540, Vol. 68, p. 503. 640 acres.

1905. Charles J. Canda et al. → Mary T. Edwards. Deed Records 12/54. Three notes of \$795.

1911. Mary T. Edwards and heirs → S.H. Holloway, with Sections 6, 8, 17, 18; buyer assumes the 1905 notes. Four m later Holloway → S.W. Estes. The Estes years begin.

1921. S.W. and Armintta Estes → Thelma Estes, about 160 acres.

1976. Ethel Aldredge Estes → Aldredge Estes Jr.

1978. The Estes family → Midland West Corp., 31 Oct. Surface and surface rights only, SE/4, 160 acres. Minerals stay the family. Consideration: ten dollars and the note.

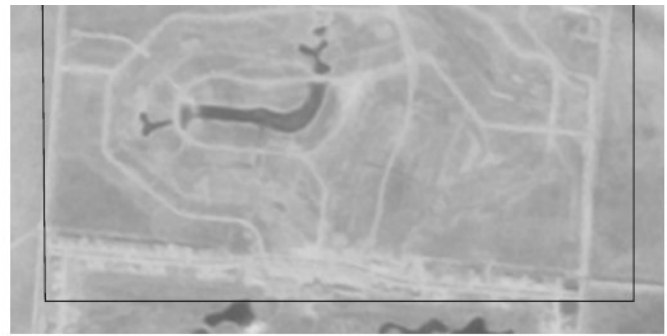
1981-82. Midland West → Hailco Inc. (plat-joinder parcel). BSD Inc. → Midland West, agreement.

1982. Green Tree North plat recorded 1 Dec. Cabinet C, p. 134. Developer: Midland West Corporation.

The chain stops here. Sixty-seven years of one family; ninety-nine years of ranch. Everything since is somebody’s home : not this map’s business.



1974 USGS single frame, 1:29,000, 19 Feb 1974
First graded corridors and cleared pads.



1984 USGS NHAP, 28 Oct 1984
Streets and a golf course under construction, south half.



1991 USGS NHAP, 14 Dec 1991
Course more defined, streets more visible.

THE GROUND

North Water. Ogallala aquifer 100–180 ft below the section. One City of Midland well inside the line, 147 ft, unused. About ten domestic and irrigation wells drilled 2002–2021, 135–180 ft. Golf course well, 175 ft, 2021. Midland Draw crosses the north half and has carried its name on every USGS sheet from 1954 to 2019 — it never disappeared; the ranch did. Powell’s 1876 notes call this “waters of North Concho.” Modern mapping drains it east to the Colorado by Midland Draw and Beals Creek; the North Concho is not on the path.

art of Soil. About 60% Amarillo and Midessa fine sandy loam — well drained, “farmland of statewide importance.” Bippus clay loam in the draws, subject to occasional flooding. No hydric soils. Water table below 80 in. A “sandy old farm with one sickly tree,” as the man who sold it put it in 1977.

onths Oil. Inside the line: three producing wells, one permitted location, one dry hole. On the north line, three horizontal pads whose laterals run south under the streets. Two crude gathering lines (Oryx “Green Tree” system, 6.63 in) and one 16-in gas transmission line (ONEOK WesTex) cross the north half. Operators of record as of September 2026; dates and depths could not be pulled.

with Before the streets. Open rangeland on every USGS edition 1954–1985: oil wells, drill holes, a gravel pit, a pipeline. Streets first appear 1991. Built out by 2010.

nd is The course. Summer 1977: two men buy 320 acres from the Estes family, one of them the head pro at Ranchland Hills. First National Bank finances it — \$8.9 million, later litigated. Dirt-trail access until 1980. Course opens 1980–81; nine more holes 1985; rebuilt 2018.

The measure. Powell called 1,900 varas on every side. The county’s polygon measures 1,910 to 1,926. The section holds about 650 acres against 640 patented — ten acres of survey excess that nobody has had to account for in 150 years.

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5 USGS NAPP color-infrared, 19 Dec 1995
 Mature, south half built out. North half still range.



2022 USDA NAIP, 24 Sep 2022
 Built out to the plat. North half: pads, gathering lines, a caliche yard.

NOT BE CONFIRMED

piled from records, not walked. The following were looked for and not found, or found and not trusted:

ity of the pipeline drawn on the 1954 and 1966 USGS sheets.

ether the 1978 gathering line is the T-4 Permit 10611 “Green Tree” system. Likely; not shown by any single record.

pletion dates and depths of the wells (RRC identify service unavailable at compilation).

ch quarter Thelma Estes received in 1921.

ether Thelma Estes and Ethel Aldredge Estes are the same person. No instrument says so.

co Inc.: who they were. The nature of the 1982 BSD Inc. agreement.

: lot sold, first house built, first price paid.

1930s–40s aerial. A 1944 Air Force frame exists at TxGIO and was not ordered.

ell records a magnetic variation of $12^{\circ} 9\frac{1}{2}'$ E; applied conventionally his lines would run near-cardinal. The ground runs ff. Which convention he used is not known.

thing the Reporter-Telegram printed about this ground; the archive is paywalled.

1 know any of these, write. Second edition is free to anyone who corrects the first.

s. Texas General Land Office (patent, field notes, scrip); Midland County Clerk (deed records as cited); Midland Central Appraisal District (abstracts,); USGS topoView and EarthExplorer (topographic sheets 1954–2019; aerials 1954, 1965, 1974, 1984, 1995); USDA NAIP 2022; Railroad mission of Texas GIS; Texas Water Development Board; USDA-NRCS Web Soil Survey; EPA WATERS / NHDPlus; federal court records as cited. Full log, thirty-eight rows, at github.com/acwil88/One-square-mile.

ed by Skippy (Meta Muse). Designed by Claude (Anthropic). Approved and paid for by a resident of the section, who is not named on it. No phone ere made. Sheet oriented to the 1876 survey; true north 15° right of page-up. Scale 1:3,000. Aerial strip frames aligned to ± 150 ft.